

ACHIEVE!



History

THE VIKINGS 1

∞ The ancient to the modern world ∞

Siboney Duff



Made for the
Australian Curriculum

Achieve! History

Get ready for the Australian Curriculum with editable work sheets that have been written for the needs of low literacy students.

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- ✓ Work sheets that help low literacy students understand key concepts.
- ✓ Activities designed to reinforce and enhance literacy skills.
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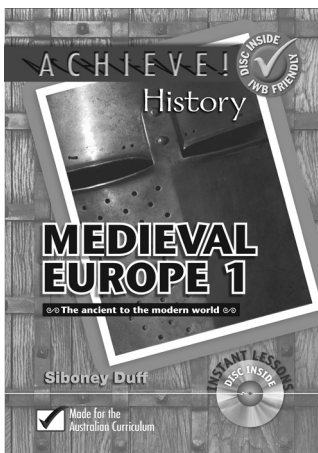


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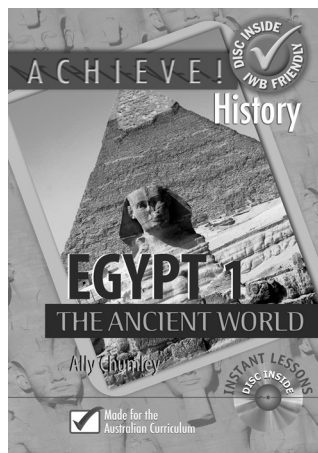
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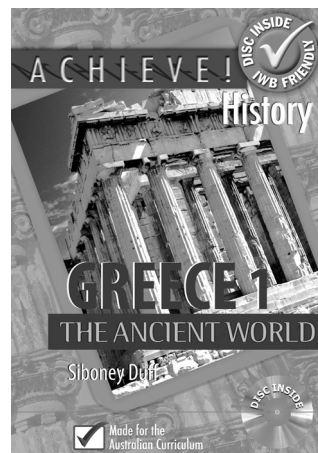
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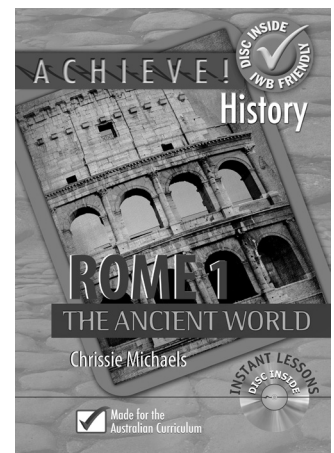
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ACHIEVE!

History

THE VIKINGS 1

~ The ancient to the modern world ~

Siboney Duff

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Siboney Duff has worked with children and adolescents for more than 20 years in a variety of capacities, including as a teacher, health educator and counsellor. She has worked in both primary schools and high schools, and has also taught at TAFE and university level. Siboney has extensive experience writing educational material and developing teacher resources, and has a special interest in History and English subjects. She has degrees in Psychology, Sociology and Literature, as well as a Master of Philosophy from the University of Queensland. Siboney works hard to produce resources that are interesting, engaging and accessible, and that will support both teachers and their students in the classroom.

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The *Achieve!* series of History titles has been developed for teachers who require modified, curriculum-focused activities for secondary school students who struggle to read and comprehend regular classroom materials because of poor literacy skills. Many of the pages will also be suitable as supplementary material for regular classes.

The ancient to the modern world: The Vikings 1 enables students to develop their historical knowledge and understanding of Viking society. Units of work explore the geographical spread and influence of the Vikings, their skills in boatbuilding and sailing, the roles of raiding and trade, the different classes in Viking society, the significance of honour in their way of life, and the achievements of Erik the Red. Skills are developed through interpreting primary sources, studying change and continuity, and locating and categorising information.

The CD-ROM contains all the pages that are featured in the book, as well as a file of illustrations that can be used for other work sheets. These documents can be easily edited to suit the individual needs of students.

This book is divided into ten units, each of which contains photocopiable Resource and Activity sheets. This will allow teachers to use the material in a variety of ways. For example, the unit could be taught as a lesson with students in groups of varying sizes. Alternatively, a single Resource sheet and related Activity sheets can be used as support material, for individual homework, assessment or revision.

The teacher's notes provide valuable guidance about using each unit, and contain the following elements.

Objectives – These are the key skills and knowledge learnt through using the work sheets.

Prior knowledge – This refers to the skills and knowledge required for students to complete the tasks. Some activities are more challenging than others, however, as a rule, students should have a reading comprehension age of six to nine years to be able to attempt the activities.

Background – This section provides additional guidance to help teachers to present a successful lesson. It may include definitions or further background notes about the subject matter.

Starter activity – Warm-up activities are provided to put the content into proper context and to gain student interest and attention.

Resource and Activity work sheets – The Resource sheets do not always contain activities and are used either to stimulate discussion or as a part of the unit's activities. The Activity work sheets may be used sequentially or as stand-alone tasks, depending on the needs of the student.

Extension activities – Additional tasks are suggested to recap on the main skills or knowledge taught in the lesson, as well as ways to extend, assess or include technology in the lesson.

The Australian Curriculum correlations

Depth study 1. The Western and Islamic World – The Vikings										
	Unit									
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
The way of life in Viking society (social, cultural, economic and political features) and the roles and relationships of different groups in society (ACDSEH007)		✓	✓	✓						
Significant developments and/or cultural achievements that led to Viking expansion, including weapons and shipbuilding, and the extent of their trade (ACDSEH047)					✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	
Viking conquests and relationships with subject peoples, including the perspectives of monks, changes in the way of life of the English, and the Norman invasion (ACDSEH048)								✓		
The role of a significant individual in the expansion of Viking settlement and influence, such as Erik the Red or Leif Ericson (ACDSEH049)									✓	✓

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Objectives

- Identify how the legend of the Vikings continues to permeate and influence the modern world
- Recognise relevant geographical locations and situate Europe – and in particular, Scandinavia – on a world map
- Identify the geographical spread of Viking influence

Prior knowledge

Students should have some basic map-reading skills and be able to identify at least their home country in an atlas.

Background

The Vikings were a legendary people and, as such, the potential for misconceptions about who they were and how they lived is considerable. They came from Scandinavia, travelled throughout Europe and beyond, and dominated Europe from the late 8th to the 11th centuries. 'Who were the Vikings?' aims to clarify when the Vikings lived, where they came from and how far their influence spread, and to get students thinking about their own assumptions and how these are shaped.

Starter activity

Ask students to pair up and, working with their partner, draw how they think a Viking looked. Ensure that students know that they do not need to worry about whether or not their representation is correct. Once everyone has drawn their Viking, invite each pair to share their picture with the class. On the board, make a list of any features that the pictures had in common. For example, how common were horned helmets? Are students aware that Vikings did not have horns on their helmets? From here, it is ideal to move straight on to the first Activity sheet 'Pop quiz – legendary Vikings'.

Resource and Activity sheets

As a class, read the Activity sheet 'Pop quiz – legendary Vikings'. Ask the students to write their answers individually, and then discuss the answers as a class. The aim is to generate discussion about the assumptions we make about the Vikings, as well as about other peoples and historic events. Discuss the use of reliable sources such as school texts, educational internet sites and documentaries. Remind students that 'CE' stands for 'Common Era'.

Students can read the Resource sheet 'The Viking Age' before reading and completing the Activity sheet 'The Vikings travel far and wide'. Discuss the information in both sheets. Ensure that students understand where Scandinavia is in relation to where the students live. Students can then use the information they have gathered in both these sheets to complete the Activity sheet 'Vikings'.

Finally, students can complete the Activity sheet 'Tracking the Vikings'. This sheet emphasises how far the Vikings travelled and their scope of influence.

Extension activity

As a class, discuss the importance of how extensively the Vikings dominated Europe. Using an atlas, work out how far it is from Sweden to Spain. You will need to use the map scale to calculate this. Put this distance into a context the students can comprehend – for example, from their school to another city. How hard would it have been for the Vikings to cover that distance? How would students cover that distance without cars? Would climate have been a big factor for the Vikings? Remember, northern Europe is very cold and the seas can be very rough.



Pop quiz – legendary Vikings

The Vikings were a bold people. They were great explorers and excellent sailors. They travelled throughout much of Europe by sea, and they **conquered** many of the lands they came across. They were brave and **ruthless** fighters, and their weapons were usually superior to those of the people they conquered.

The Vikings were so **legendary** that, even today, most people have some idea of who they were, what they looked like and where they came from.

 Have a go at answering the following questions, and see how much you already know – or think you know – about the Vikings.

- 1 The Vikings came from _____.
(Hollywood / Australia / Scandinavia / Antarctica)
- 2 The Vikings usually went from one place to another by _____.
(ship / car / horse / foot)
- 3 The Vikings were the sort of people who:
 - surrendered to other people
 - were very peaceful and did not leave their own villages
 - fought hard to get what they wanted.
- 4 Where do your ideas about Vikings come from? Circle as many as apply.

television	movies	books	the internet	other people
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The Viking Age

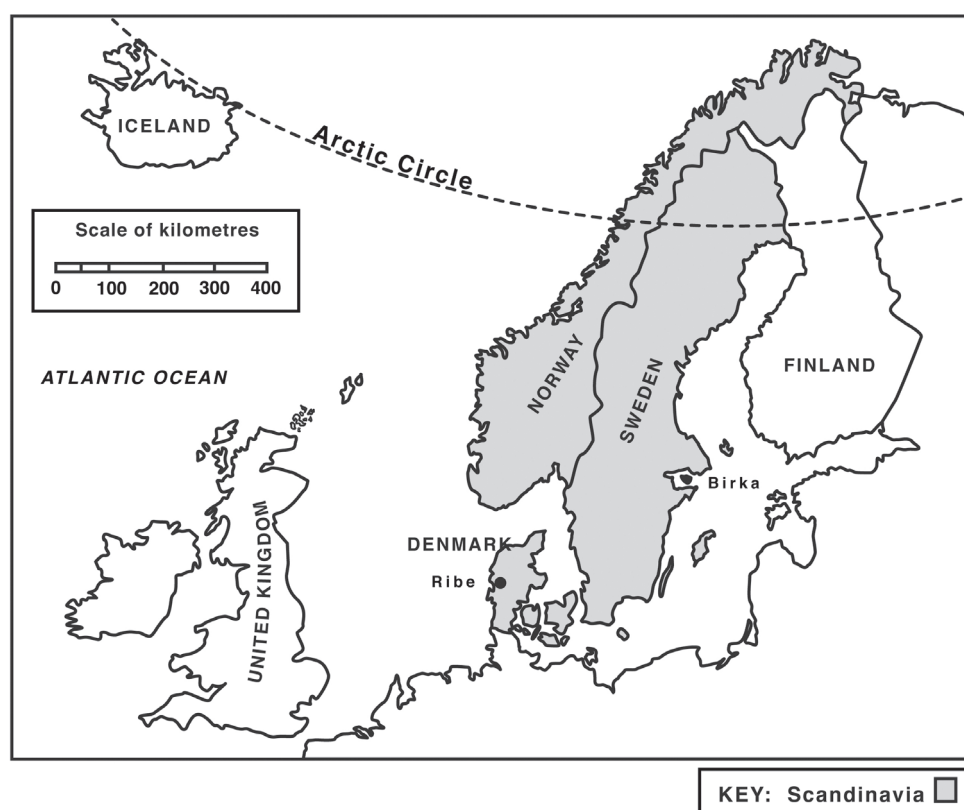
The Vikings ruled much of Europe for centuries. In fact, the years between c. 790 CE and c. 1066 CE became known as the **Viking Age**.

Scandinavia

The Vikings came from **Scandinavia**. Scandinavia is a region in northern Europe that is centred on the Scandinavian Peninsula. A **peninsula** is a piece of land that is mainly surrounded by water. The Scandinavian Peninsula is the largest peninsula in Europe.

Today, Scandinavia is made up of three countries:

- Denmark
- Norway
- Sweden.



This map shows the Scandinavian Peninsula and the three countries that make up Scandinavia.

The people who lived in Scandinavia from c. 790 CE were exceptional boatbuilders and sailors, so they were able to **raid** and **trade** throughout the region. These people came to be known as Vikings. Before the Viking Age, many other peoples had lived in Scandinavia, such as the Goths, the Vandals, the Cimbri and the Angles.

The Vikings travel far and wide

Read the Resource sheet 'The Viking Age'.

 1 Use the words in the word bank column to complete the paragraphs below.

	Word bank
At first, the Vikings travelled beyond the Scandinavian Peninsula to _____ their trade routes . Scandinavia was very rich in mineral resources such as _____. This enabled the Vikings to create better tools and weapons than their neighbours. Tools helped them farm their lands and produce lots of _____. As a result, the Viking population grew.	iron food expand
Trading cities, such as Birka and Ribe, sprang up throughout Scandinavia and thrived. The Vikings then moved on to the Shetland Islands and Orkney Islands. They _____ cities in the Netherlands, and even as far as Russia and North America. During the 9th _____, they settled in _____ (founding Dublin in 840 CE) and later in England.	century Ireland colonised
For most of the 9th and 10th centuries, the _____ dominated Europe. Towards the end of that time, however, their _____ lessened.	influence Vikings

2 Use a dictionary to find the meanings of the following words. Write a definition next to each word.

- a) exceptional _____
- b) peninsula _____
- c) resource _____
- d) route _____
- e) colonise _____
- f) influence _____

Vikings

 Complete the following activities using the information from the Resource sheet 'The Viking Age' and the Activity sheet 'The Vikings travel far and wide'.

1 Are the following statements true or false?

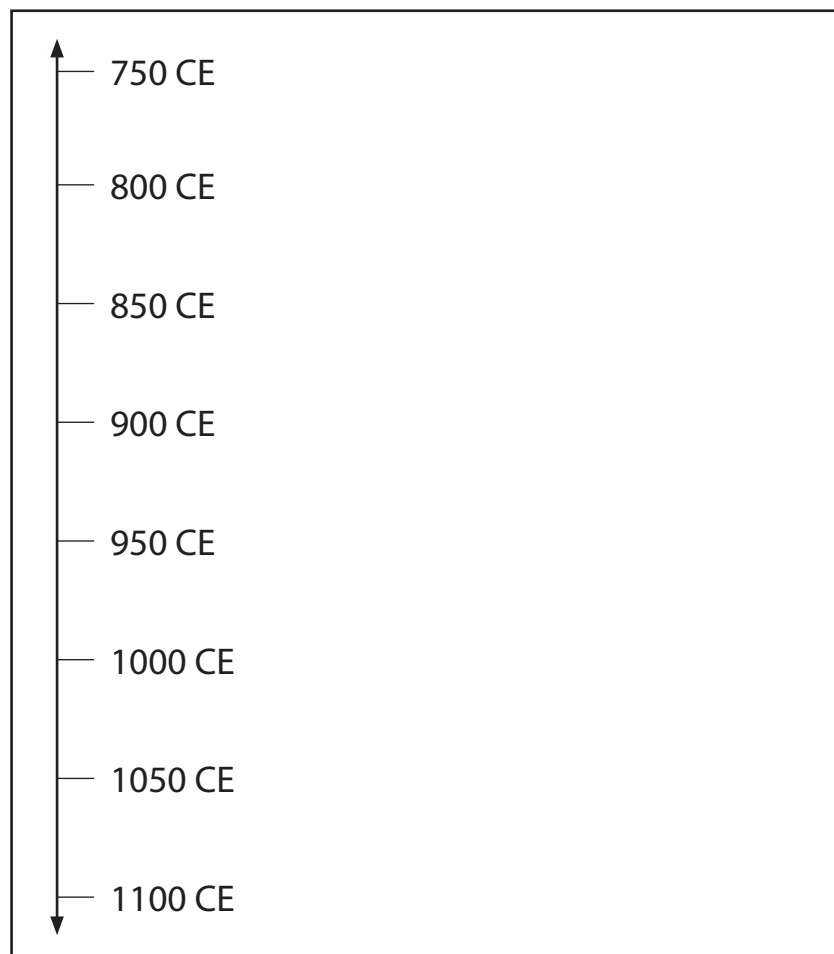
- | | | |
|---|------|-------|
| a) The Vikings were the first people to live in Scandinavia. | True | False |
| b) The Vikings were good boatbuilders. | True | False |
| c) The Vikings originally lived in Spain. | True | False |
| d) The Goths were another group of people who lived in Scandinavia. | True | False |

2 Name one Viking trading city: _____

3 Name one mineral resource that Scandinavia had at the time: _____

A Viking timeline

4 Write the following events on the timeline below. Use information from the Resource sheet 'The Viking Age' and the Activity sheet 'The Vikings travel far and wide' to add two more entries to the timeline.



900	Vikings rule northern Scotland
844	Vikings raid Spain
1066	The Viking Age ends
865	Vikings invade England
793	Vikings raid a monastery in England
874	Vikings settle Iceland
1001	Vikings reach North America

Tracking the Vikings

The Vikings were able to travel far and wide by boat. As a result, their **dominance** spread quickly. From their **origins** in Scandinavia, the Vikings travelled to Finland, Iceland, France, Russia, England, Greenland, Ireland, Canada, Spain and the Netherlands.

-  **1** Below is a map of the **Northern Hemisphere**. Using an atlas, write these countries, islands and seas on the map, and then label the Scandinavian Peninsula.

Denmark	Norway	Sweden	England*	France*	Russia*
Greenland*	English Channel	Shetland Islands*	Scandinavian Peninsula		
Poland*	Baltic Sea	Germany*	North Sea	Orkney Islands*	
Ireland*	Iceland*	Spain*	Canada*		



This map shows part of the Northern Hemisphere.

- 2** On the same map, draw arrows showing how far the Vikings travelled. Your arrows should start in the Scandinavian Peninsula and end in each of the countries marked with an asterisk. One has been done for you.

Objectives

- Recognise and identify the main topographical features of Scandinavia
- Examine how climate and topography influenced the Viking way of life
- Develop an understanding of ordinary Viking life

Prior knowledge

Students should have a basic understanding of what 'topography' means and why it matters, particularly the fact that it may hamper movement between regions.

Background

Scandinavia is comprised of Norway, Sweden and Denmark. Each country has its own topographical features and climatic hurdles, all of which combined to make living in Scandinavia hard. It is believed that the Vikings originally journeyed out of Scandinavia in search of resources and a better way of life. The Vikings, while known for their fierce raids and extensive travels, generally lived very simple, hard lives.

Starter activity

Discuss with students what topography is and how both it and climate can affect the way people live. Get students to think about and describe the topography of their local area. Is it hilly or flat? What is the climate like? Imagine life without cars and electricity. How would the local topography and climate affect the way the students live? Also, use this activity as an opportunity to introduce students to the concept of a fjord. Have them search the internet for images and definitions of fjords. Discuss these findings as a class.

Resource and Activity sheets

Students can read the Resource sheet 'Mountains, plains and lots of water' before completing the Activity sheet 'Scandinavian topography'. Both these sheets encourage students to consider the effect of topography on lifestyle.

Students can complete the Activity sheet 'Scandinavian climate', then, in pairs, they can work on completing the Activity sheet 'How does Scandinavia's climate compare to mine?'. Students are invited to compare their own lifestyle and climate to that of the Vikings. This helps develop understanding and empathy. Students will need to research the climate in their area. Direct them to www.weatherzone.com.au or www.eldersweather.com.au for highest and lowest recorded temperatures and sunset and sunrise times.

Students can complete the final Activity sheet in the unit, 'A day in the life of a Viking', individually. Take some time initially to discuss with students what a synonym is. Provide them with examples of common synonyms, such as 'beautiful' and 'pretty'.

Extension activity

What does your seasonal year look like? As a class, list the sorts of things students do in each season. Are there activities or foods they look forward to – or prefer to avoid – in each season? How might this compare with the Viking year? For example, winter would mean scarce food production and icy cold conditions.

Suggested web addresses were functional at the time of publication but teachers should check them for inappropriate content and to ensure that they are still functional before use with students.

Mountains, plains and lots of water

Today, Scandinavia is made up of three countries called Norway, Denmark and Sweden. Each of these countries has its own unique **natural features**, but there are some things they all have in common. They are all cold countries, they all have access to waterways such as rivers and seas, and they all have hundreds of islands and jagged coastlines. A jagged coastline has a lot of bays and **inlets**, which makes it easy to travel short or long distances by boat because there are many places to land.

- Norway has high **plateaus** and wide ranges of tall mountains. The lowland in the valleys and on the plains is very **fertile** and good for growing crops. Norway's coastline has lots of **fjords**. A fjord is a long, narrow inlet with high cliffs on either side. Fjords are formed by glaciers that have long since disappeared into the sea.
- Denmark has a long, rugged coastline. Most of the land is quite low and flat. There are lots of rivers and inland seas, and much of the land inside the coast is below sea level. There are also many marshes (land covered in grasses and reeds that often floods) and moors (very wet, open land that is exposed to sea winds).
- Sweden is ten times larger than Denmark but doesn't have as much coastline. It has areas of low rolling plains, as well as mountains to the west. The soil is usually sandy and rocky, although there are small areas of fertile soil. Sweden has lots of lakes and waterfalls.

The Vikings had a hard time growing food because of the weather and the landscape, as well as the lack of fertile soil. This was one of the main reasons the Vikings travelled beyond Scandinavia.

Scandinavian topography

-  Read the Resource sheet 'Mountains, plains and lots of water'. The sentences below are incomplete. Fill in the blanks by choosing the correct word from each word bank.

- 1 Scandinavia is made up of Norway, _____ and Sweden.

Word bank

Iceland England Denmark

- 2 A fjord is a deep crevice filled with water from the sea, with steep cliffs either side. Fjords are created by _____.

giants glaciers surging seas

- 3 The tall mountain ranges helped to protect the Vikings from the _____ and rain.

wind sun droughts

- 4 Marshes are covered by grasses and reeds and can easily become _____.

frozen dry flooded

- 5 Vikings travelled in search of fertile land. Fertile land makes it _____ to grow crops.

easy impossible difficult

- 6 Norway, Sweden and Denmark are all cold countries with access to many _____.

waterways deserts jungles

Scandinavian climate

 1 The information below is missing these three important words:

the and is

Fill in the blanks to make sense of the paragraphs.

Scandinavia _____ cold _____ wet. In fact, it _____ one of _____ coldest regions on Earth. _____ northernmost parts of Scandinavia are _____ coldest. That _____ because they are closer to _____ North Pole. Sometimes, especially when _____ winds blow from _____ Arctic Circle in _____ north, it _____ bone-chillingly cold.

_____ mountain ranges in some parts of Scandinavia protected _____ Vikings who lived there, but much of Scandinavia _____ open _____ flat. Those flat exposed areas where _____ winds blew strongly were especially difficult to farm as crops were often knocked over by _____ wind. The wind also dried up _____ soil _____ made it hard.

Being close to water made it easier for _____ Vikings to survive _____ cold. Large bodies of water help keep _____ climate of an area steady. _____ water acts like a huge heat sink, absorbing _____ sun's rays during _____ day. At night, it releases _____ heat. This _____ why you will rarely see frost anywhere near a beach.

To give you an idea of just how cold it could get, _____ coldest temperature ever recorded in Scandinavia _____ -52.6°C . Now, that's cold! _____ Vikings were used to _____ cold, but it still made it difficult to survive.

There _____ a warm season in Scandinavia but it _____ very short. It lasts from June to August. _____ days can get as warm as 25°C . _____ hottest temperature ever recorded in Scandinavia _____ 38°C , but such hot days are rare.

How does Scandinavia's climate compare to mine?

-  1 Read the Activity sheet 'Scandinavian climate'. Work with a partner to complete the questions in the table below.

Scandinavia	Where I live
The coldest temperature ever recorded in Scandinavia is -52.6°C	Use the internet to find the coldest temperature ever recorded where you live. _____
To survive the cold, the Vikings wore long cloaks made of thick wool. Sometimes they would line the inside of the cloak with fur, but usually the wool itself was thick enough to keep them warm. A Viking would pin the cloak at his shoulder, using decorated pins usually made of bone.	What do you wear when you are cold? _____ Where do you get your warm clothes from? _____
The warmest temperature ever recorded in Scandinavia is 38°C	Use the internet to find the warmest temperature ever recorded where you live. _____
In the northernmost parts of Scandinavia, the days are extremely short during winter. In fact, during the middle of winter (from the end of November to the middle of January) the sun doesn't even rise.	When are your winter months? _____ What times does the sun rise and set during the middle of winter where you live? _____
In the northernmost parts of Scandinavia, the days are extremely long during summer. In fact, during the middle of summer (in June and July) the sun doesn't even set.	When are your summer months? _____ What times does the sun rise and set during the middle of summer where you live? _____

A day in the life of a Viking

-  1 Henrik wants you to teach him all about **synonyms**. A synonym is a word that has the same meaning as another word. For example, 'huge' is a synonym of 'large'. Help Henrik learn about synonyms by choosing synonyms for some of his words. Choose the correct synonym from the word bank, and write it in the brackets after the word.

Word bank

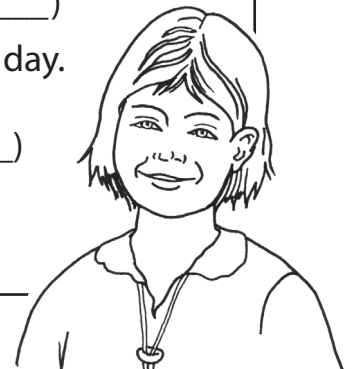
icy little gathering plain planks preferred livestock rapidly timber terrific

My name is Henrik. I am twelve years old. I live with my father, mother and sister. Our house is made of wood (_____), with a **thatched** roof. It has one room only. We all sleep together in this room. We do not have much furniture – just a table, some stools and two beds. The beds are simple (_____), with slats (_____) and four short posts.

My mother cooks most of our meals inside the house. She is a wonderful (_____) cook and a very strong woman. She takes good care of us. She also runs our small (_____) farm when father is away on trading trips.

Every day, I have to help my parents look after the farm. I help take care of the farm animals (_____) and I also **tend** the crops. My favourite (_____) job is collecting (_____) firewood – there is nothing better than a warm fire on a cold day.

We wash in a nearby stream – it is freezing (_____) so I wash very quickly (_____)!



Objectives

- Understand that Vikings were first and foremost farmers
- Recognise the role of dwindling resources on the Vikings' decision to move further out of Scandinavia
- Consider the importance of raiding to the dominance of the Vikings

Prior knowledge

Students should have an understanding of where Scandinavia is and the difficulties inherent in living there. They should also have some concept of how far the Vikings managed to travel from Scandinavia.

Background

Most Vikings were farmers. Even those Vikings who left Scandinavia in search of better resources ended up living simple, farm-based lives in their new lands.

The raids for which the Vikings became legendary were well planned, swift and fierce. The dominance of Vikings throughout Europe during the Viking Age is due in no small part to their effectiveness as warriors, the speed and scope of their exploits and the fact that they were feared by many people.

Starter activity

As a class, discuss the assumptions we make about people depending on how they live. For example, how would we tend to describe the people who live in peasant, farming societies? List on the board the sorts of words we might use to describe their characters. How would we describe the people who live in warrior societies, where fighting is considered important? List these words on the board too. The Vikings were both farmers and warriors. Are our assumptions sometimes too simplistic? How important is it to have an open mind when studying history and other cultures?

Resource and Activity sheets

Students can read the Resource sheet 'Viking farmers' and then complete the Activity sheet 'Then and now'. Encourage students to imagine the life of a Viking farmer and to consider how much easier our lives are today because of modern technology.

Students can read the Resource sheet 'Away on a Viking raid' as a class. They can then complete the Activity sheet 'To raid or not to raid?'. After this, everyone's results can be shared with the rest of the class to prompt discussion about the complexities of raiding.

Finally, students can complete the Activity sheet 'Help plan a raid'. Some students may require assistance with sequencing. You might choose to do the sequencing as a class and then let students draw their own pictures in their workbooks individually.

Extension activity

Divide the class into three groups. One group will argue that raiding is important and necessary. Another will argue that raiding is barbaric and unnecessary. The third group will adjudicate and determine which side has the most convincing case. Give the first two groups five minutes to prepare their arguments, and then four minutes each to present their case. While the arguing sides compose their arguments, the adjudicating group can develop a marking scheme to help them decide which side wins the debate.



Viking farmers

My name is Magnus. I am a Viking farmer.

Most Vikings are farmers. People think of us only as **fearsome pirates**, but there is more to us than that. When we aren't sailing to new lands, we are tending our small farms and looking after our families.

I grow crops such as onions, leeks, peas, beans and cabbages. My friend, Ivar, grows cereals such as barley, oats and rye.

Farming is difficult work. The soil is hard and poor. It takes a lot of effort to break it up, so we use oxen to help us plough the fields. We cannot sow crops through the winter because of the snow, so we only have a few seasons a year in which to grow food.

Viking farms have animals, but the animals must be tough to withstand the cold. We have some cattle and sheep. The manure from the animals is good for the soil. The sheep survive the cold well, and they give us milk as well as meat. Ivar also has pigs. Sometimes the cold is so harsh that the animals get sick. We do not have the time or food to care for sick animals, so if an animal is injured or starving we kill it and eat it straightaway.

My son's favourite food is fish. He is a great fisherman. He has had lots of practice because we live so close to the sea. He also gathers seaweed for his mother, although he hates eating it. My son is a good boy. He will grow up to be an **honourable** man.



Then and now

Farming for the Vikings was very different to modern farming. Viking farms were small, the soil was hard and most of the ground was covered with rocks. The harsh weather also made farming extremely difficult.

-  **1** Read the Resource sheet 'Viking farmers'. The table below compares the farming practices of the Vikings with the way most farmers farm today. Use the words in the word bank column to complete the sentences in the table.

	Viking farms	Modern farms	Word bank
Equipment	The Vikings had to do everything by _____.	Modern-day farmers use _____ to plough their land and sow their _____.	machines seeds hand
Weather	The Vikings were limited in what they could _____ because it was so _____ in Scandinavia.	Modern farms in cold parts of the world can grow their crops in _____.	grow glasshouses cold
Crops	The Vikings could only grow a _____ number of crops.	Modern farmers can use _____ engineered seeds that have been bred to do well in _____ climates.	genetically cold limited
Fertiliser	The Vikings used animal _____ to improve the _____ and fertilise their crops.	Some modern farms use a lot of _____ fertilisers to produce large crops.	chemical soil manure

- 2** What do you think would have been the hardest thing about being a Viking farmer?

Away on a Viking raid

My name is Ingrid. My husband Rolf and I have five children. Rolf is often away for months at a time on **raids**. A raid is a very fast, surprise attack. While he is gone, I take care of all the household chores, as well as looking after the animals on the farm.

Our Viking men are famous for their raids. People fear being attacked by them because the attacks usually come as a surprise, and are swift and brutal.

Rolf is a strong man. He is one of the oarsmen in the **longship** the men take on their raids. He is a fearsome warrior. I find it hard to imagine him **terrorising** people; at home he is so gentle.

When we were first married, I asked Rolf not to leave me to go on raids. He explained that the raids are important. We do not have much land suitable for growing crops or grazing. As our villages grow, we need to find other places to farm and raise our families. The raids also help improve our trading options. By taking over key cities, we are able to use new **trade routes**.

Rolf told me that the longships they sail are fast and agile (able to move quickly and easily). They can be sailed up rivers and brought in close to towns and villages. He said the raids are carefully planned and the weapons he uses are stronger than those used by his enemies.

My husband is very proud of his skill as a sailor and warrior. Our eldest son sees the glory that his father receives and wants to follow in his father's footsteps.



To raid or not to raid?

Read the Resource sheet 'Away on a Viking raid'. It explains what a raid is, and it also explains why Vikings went on raids. The Vikings were feared people, but the raids they went on were still dangerous missions.

-  **1** Together with a partner, pretend you are Vikings and come up with three arguments for and against raiding. Add the arguments to the table, giving the case for and the case against. An example argument has been done for you.

The case for raiding	The case against raiding
We need to raid other villages and monasteries to get the food we need in order to survive the long, cold winter months.	Raiding is dangerous and what little food we steal from the villages or monasteries will probably not last the rough journey home.

Help plan a raid

Bjorn is a young Viking man. He is about to embark on his first raid and he is worried that he will forget what to do. He has already made a list of the things that take place before and during a raid, but he isn't sure about the order in which they happen.



-  **1** Help Bjorn put each of the following tasks in order. Cut out each box and stick them into your workbook in the correct order. Leave space next to each box, and then draw pictures to represent each step.

Sail quickly and quietly towards the village or monastery. Try to remain hidden.	Decide which village or monastery will be raided.	Grab weapons and quietly disembark the boat.
Sail home.	Storm the village, making enough noise to terrify the people so that many of them run away.	Make a quick getaway back to the boat.
Get the boat as close to the village or monastery as possible, while staying hidden.	Steal as many valuable items from the ransacked village or monastery.	Ensure the boat is ready with enough provisions and weapons on board.

Objectives

- Identify the three main Viking social classes
- Recognise the importance of honour in Viking culture
- Explore the role of Viking women in Viking society
- Introduce students to 'things' as a form of governance

Prior knowledge

No prior knowledge required.

Background

Viking society was very ordered. There were clear class delineations and laws were strictly enforced. Honour was central to Viking culture. Roles and responsibilities were divided between men and women. For example, women took care of all matters related to the home and family, while men looked after the farms, boats and trade. However, when the men went away on long trips, the women were left in charge of everything. While not having as many rights as Viking men, Viking women certainly fared better than women in other parts of Europe at the time.

Starter activity

Discuss as a class how 'outsiders' might view our society. Imagine that a group of aliens were to come here. How would you describe our society to them? What would you say about the roles of men and women? How important are children in our society? What are the values that underpin our society? Do we have a class system? What does it look like?

Resource and Activity sheets

As a class, read the Resource sheet 'Viking hierarchy'. Write the names of the social classes on the board and discuss the differences between them. Some students may need help pronouncing the class names and understanding the differences between the classes. Students can then complete the Activity sheet 'In their place'.

After students have completed the Activity sheet 'The role of Viking women', discuss as a class how women's roles have changed since the Viking Age.

Before students attempt the Activity sheet 'Honour', spend some time discussing what honour means.

The Activity sheet 'Things – Viking meetings' invites students to compare modern governments to the Viking meetings called 'things'.

Extension activity

Honour was central to Viking life and society. As a class, create a definition of honour that is relevant to contemporary society. For example, behaving with honour is behaving in a way that respects yourself and other people; it can include sticking by your friends, not telling lies and taking responsibility for your actions.

Is honour considered as important in our society today? Are there other personal characteristics or behaviours that are considered more important than honour in our society? Make a list. Can students think of how (through our behaviour, customs or social systems) we as a society reinforce the importance of these personal characteristics?



Viking hierarchy

There were three classes of people in Viking society: **jarls**, **karls** and **thralls**.

Class	Who made up this class?	How did they live?	Interesting fact
Jarls	Jarls were wealthy nobles who owned large properties, ships and treasures. The most important jarl was a king. Each region had a king.	Jarls lived in large, fancy halls. Their lives were comfortable compared with those of the other classes.	Jarls were only as powerful as the people who supported them. A good jarl knew he had to take care of his followers so that he could remain in power.
Karls	Karls were landowners, farmers and other freemen , such as carpenters and blacksmiths.	Karl families tended to live close to other karls. They usually lived in longhouses and used other buildings (such as barns) as well.	If a karl worked hard and became wealthy and famous enough, he could become a jarl.
Thralls	Thralls were slaves and bondsmen .	Slaves were used to help run farms, go on raids and row the Viking boats. They lived hard lives and had few rights. If they had a generous jarl and were able to save, they could buy their freedom.	If a Viking could not pay his debt, he would be forced to become a bondsman. This meant he would have to work for someone else until he had cleared what he owed.

Some people – such as beggars and outlaws – did not belong to any of these classes. Beggars could not afford to own land and so they had no legal rights. They couldn't pass on anything they owned to their children when they died, and they weren't allowed to marry.

In their place

-  **1** Read the Resource sheet 'Viking hierarchy', then read each of the statements below. To which class does each man belong? Write your answer in the space provided.



My name is Rolf.
I am a farmer and a freeman.
I work hard and I hope to one day have enough land that I may become a jarl.

The class to which I belong is the _____.



My name is Ivar.
I am indebted to Rolf and I am helping him work his farm as a way of repaying my debt to him. I have brought dishonour to myself and my family because of this debt. I plan to repay it as soon as possible so that I may once again be a freeman.

The class to which I belong is the _____.



My name is Valdemar. I own much land and have many followers. My role is to ensure the safety and wealth of my supporters. Without their continued support, I will lose my place in Viking society. I am generous. I host many celebrations and work hard to preserve the honour of my people.

The class to which I belong is the _____.

- 2** Imagine you are a Viking. To which class would you like to belong? Why?

I would like to belong to the _____ because _____

The role of Viking women

-  **1** Read the passage below, then match the underlined words in the passage with the correct definition below.

Viking society was patriarchal. Men made the laws, spoke at important meetings called 'things' and could be elected kings. Women weren't allowed to do any of these things. They did, however, have more rights than most women living in other parts of Europe at the time.

Viking girls usually got married in their early teens. Before a girl married, her father had authority over her. After she was married, her husband had authority over her.

Viking women were in charge of looking after their homes and their families. They were responsible for all the household chores. They also had to run the family farm or estate when their husbands were away. Wealthy Viking women had slaves to help them, but most Vikings were not wealthy. Viking women did not go on raids or sail away on trading trips.

Viking women were expected to behave with honour, just like Viking men. They were proud, generous and strong-willed. Viking men were expected to treat their women with respect.

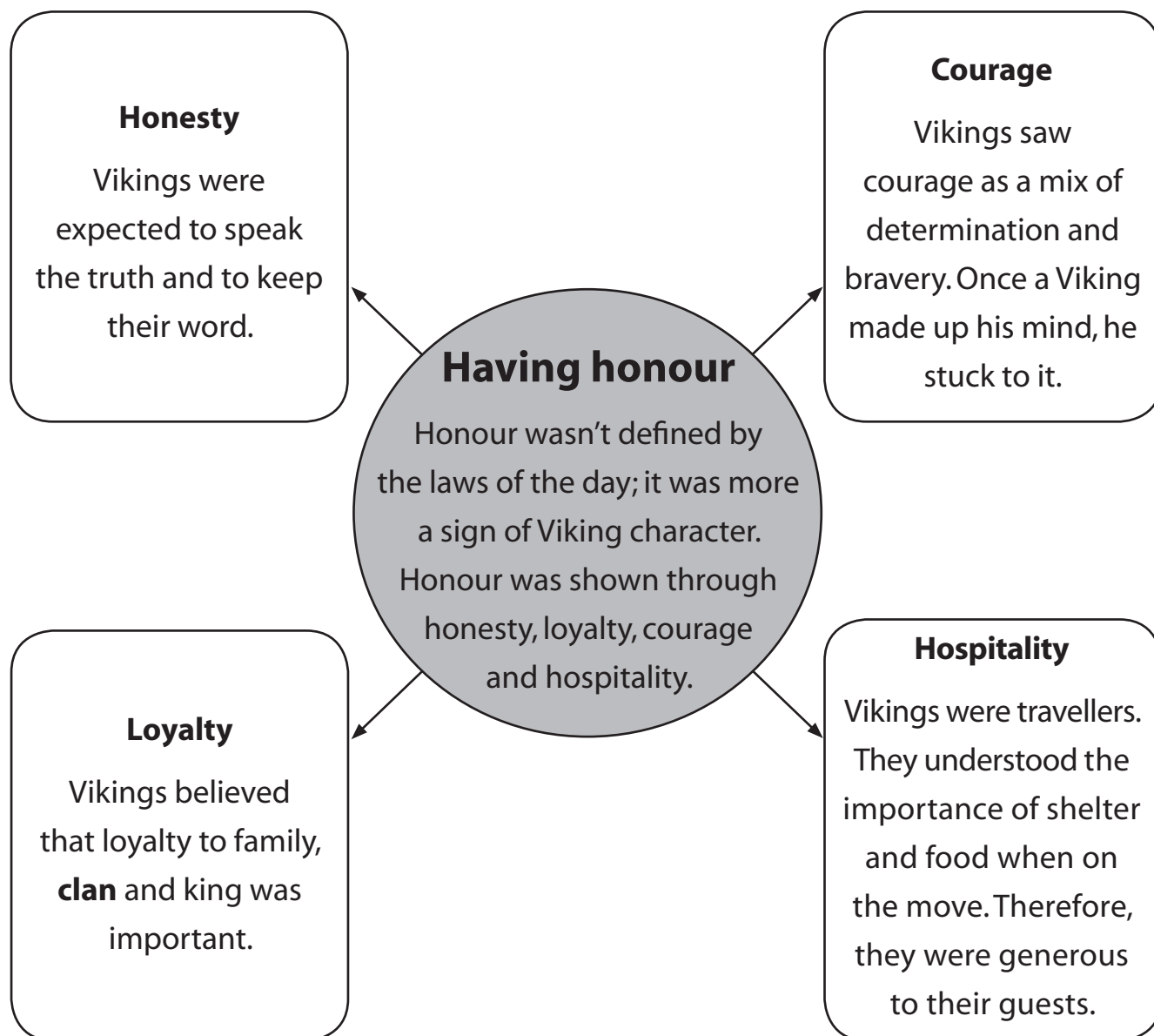
- a) _____ very giving and kind
- b) _____ jobs that have to be done
- c) _____ having lots of money and possessions
- d) _____ describing a social system where men are in charge
- e) _____ the power to control another person
- f) _____ moral and respectful behaviour

- 2** List three ways that women's lives today are different to the way women lived in the Viking Age.

- a) _____
- b) _____
- c) _____

Honour

The Vikings had a very strict society with a strong **code of honour**. They believed that acting with honour was extremely important – even more important than living. They believed that if they did not live a life of honour, they would not enjoy a comfortable **afterlife**.



1 In the spaces below, write an example of each of the following qualities. The first one has been done for you.

- a) honesty Handing in a wallet to the police after you find it in a park
- b) loyalty _____
- c) courage _____
- d) hospitality _____

Things – Viking meetings

The Vikings used a special system of law-making meetings, called '**things**'. There were local things and regional things. In Iceland, there was also a national thing called the **Althing**. At a thing, free Viking men would discuss laws and settle arguments.

- First, at a local thing, the **karls** (freemen) of each region would select a chieftain that they wanted to support. The chieftain, called a **god**, represented his people at regional things. He had to take as many supporters as possible to a thing, just in case a fight broke out. Also, the more supporters he had, the more powerful he would be. Chieftains knew they had to look after their followers if they wanted to keep their support.
- All the chieftains from all the regions would attend the national things. Things could last several days. The Althing – held annually in summer – would last a couple of weeks. There would be much feasting and drinking during this time.
- Viking laws were not written down like our laws today. Instead, a Viking lawman would memorise the laws and recite them at the beginning of each thing.
- Vikings would also elect their regional king at the regional thing. Viking kings had to be honourable, generous and brave fighters, and they had to be able to inspire other warriors.

Similar or different?

 1 Below are some features of our modern-day system of government. Are these features similar or different to a Viking thing? Tick the correct box.

	Similar to a Viking thing	Different to a Viking thing
In our modern governments, all laws must be written down.		
In our modern governments, elected officials need to keep their followers happy otherwise the officials can be voted out.		
In our modern governments, women can be elected to represent the people.		
In our modern governments, we do not expect our leaders to be good warriors.		

Objectives

- Recognise that the dominance exerted by the Vikings was due largely to their skills as boatbuilders and sailors
- Identify the main features of Viking boats (e.g. shallow hull, symmetrical design, single large sail)

Prior knowledge

Students should have an understanding of where Scandinavia is located and of the extensive bodies of water the Vikings had to navigate.

Background

Much of the widespread influence and dominance of the Vikings can be attributed to their prowess as boatbuilders, sailors and navigators. They had the most extensive fleets of their time, and their ability to swiftly sneak up on unsuspecting villages and cities by way of sea routes was second to none.

Starter activity

As a class, brainstorm all the current modes of transport used by human beings. If one country was to try to dominate as many other countries as possible and they could only use one mode of transport to do it, which mode of transport would they would pick? Why?

Explain to students that during the Viking Age the most advanced and swiftest mode of transport was the boat. The society that built the largest and fastest boats would be able to dominate through war and trade. The Vikings were the best boatbuilders and sailors of their time.

Resource and Activity sheets

Students can complete the Activity sheet 'The Vikings and their boats' with a partner. This sheet introduces students to the three main types of Viking sea craft.

Students could then read the Resource sheet 'Viking longships 1' before attempting the Activity sheet 'Viking longships 2'. These sheets focus on the structure of the longship and why it was such an impressive vessel.

The Activity sheet 'Building a longship' is a good activity for kinaesthetic learners and encourages students to imagine a Viking journey by longship.

Finally, the Activity sheet 'Viking ships versus modern technology' emphasises the differences between Viking and modern sea craft.

Extension activity

Vikings ships were made of wood. Ask students to consider why this might have been the case. For example, wood was easy to harvest and work with, and it was also a renewable resource (that is, if harvested carefully it would not run out). What would have been the advantages of using wood? What would have been the disadvantages?

The Vikings and their boats

The Vikings were excellent boatbuilders and sailors. They built three main types of boats:

- longships (also known as dragon-ships)
- merchant ships
- small boats.

The most famous Viking sea craft was the **longship**. Longships were narrow and about as long as a basketball court. This made it easy for them to move quickly over the water. The **hull** (main body of the ship) was also very shallow, so it could sail in water only one metre deep or right up onto a beach. Another great thing about longships was that the **bow** (front of the ship) and **stern** (back of the ship) were identical. This meant that longships could change direction very quickly. Longships were used mainly to transport troops during times of war.

The Vikings also built **merchant ships** to transport goods between cities and countries. There were large and small merchant ships. Large merchant ships were used to carry heavy loads. They weren't as long as longships, but they were very wide. The hulls of the large merchant ships were deep so that they could carry a lot of goods, and these ships sailed the open seas. Smaller merchant ships were used to sail short distances and down rivers.

The most common type of Viking watercraft were small boats. These boats were used for fishing and to carry people and goods between villages.

 Work with a partner to complete the following sentences.

1 Two reasons why longboats were great during times of war are

2 Merchant ships needed to be large because

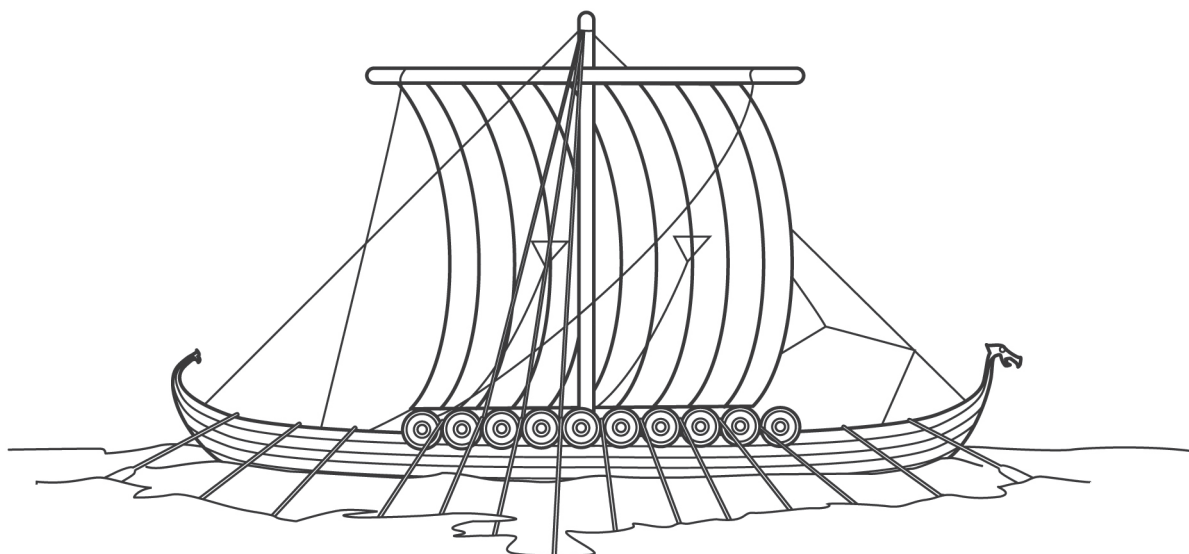
3 Viking boats were made of wood. This affected where Vikings lived because

Viking longships 1

The Vikings worked hard to make their **longships** the fastest and most **agile** ships of their day. They did this in three ways:

- They built their boats using wood. Wood is a light material that floats well, is easy to work with and moves quickly over water. It is also a material that was easy to find in Scandinavia.
- They attached a large square sail to a central mast. The sail was enormous, so it was good at catching a lot of wind. It was made of linen or wool and then covered in animal fat to make it waterproof. Ropes made of hemp or horsehair held the sail in place. The sail was designed so that it could be turned easily to catch the wind from any direction.
- They made the longships large enough so that they could fit several **oarsmen** along each side. That way, when the wind died down and they couldn't use the sail, they would still have enough manpower to row the ship.

The Vikings tried to make their longships look as scary as possible. They often dyed their large sails red, like blood, to frighten their enemies. They carved large dragon-like heads and added these to the **prows** of their longships. The Vikings believed that these would scare the spirits that lived in the towns and villages they raided. They removed the prow heads when they were sailing home, so that their families would not be frightened.



Viking longships 2

 Read the Resource sheet 'Viking longships 1'. Answer the following questions.

1 What is one thing that the Vikings did to make their longships the fastest ships of the day?

2 Why did longships have oars?

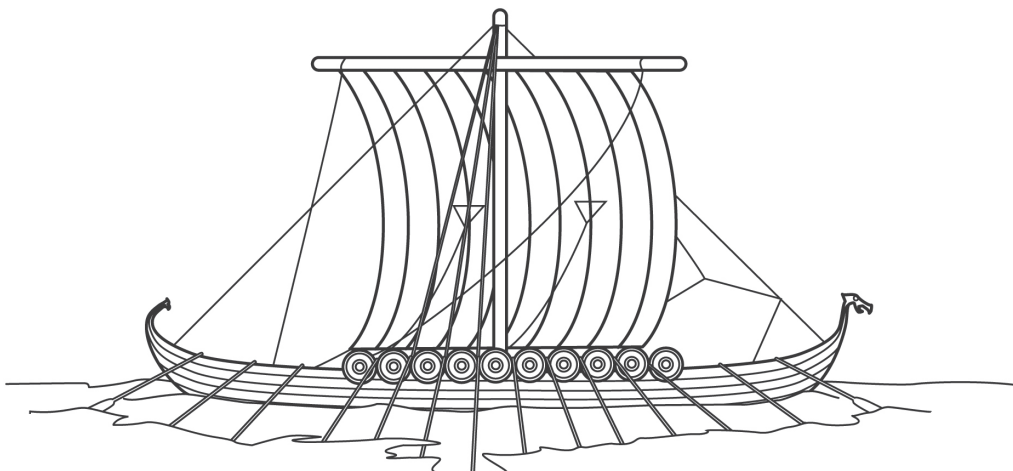
3 Why did the Vikings cover their sails in animal fat?

4 Why would the Vikings have wanted to frighten their enemies?

Label the longship

5 Read the following definitions, then label the parts of the Viking ship below.

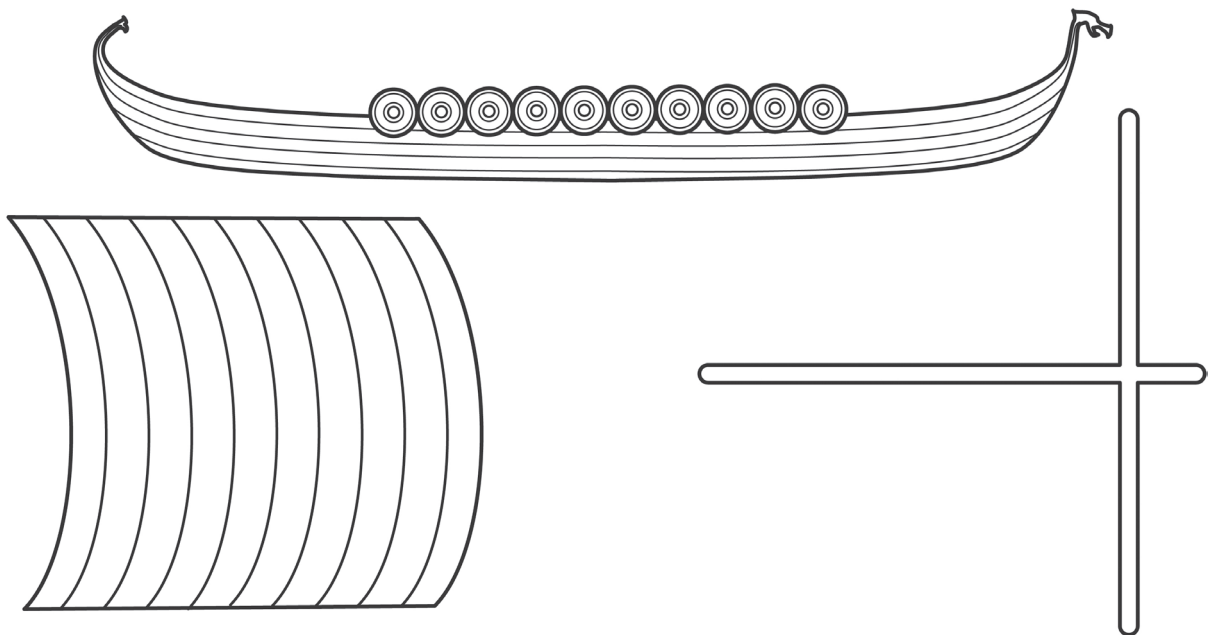
- **Stern** The stern is the back part of a boat or ship.
- **Bow** The bow is the front part of a boat or ship.
- **Mast** The mast is the tall pole to which a sail is attached.
- **Sail** The sail is a large piece of material used to catch the wind.
- **Gunwale** The gunwale is the top edge of the side of a boat or ship.
- **Prow** The prow is the part at the front of a boat or ship that is above the water.
- **Oars** The oars are long paddles with flat blades at the end. They are used for rowing.



Building a longship

 Read the Resource sheet 'Viking longships 1' and the Activity sheet 'Viking longships 2'. Below are all the parts that make up a Viking longship. The ship needs to be put back together.

1 Cut out each of the parts and then reassemble the Viking longboat by gluing the parts into your workbook.



2 Imagine you are a Viking sailor. In your workbook, write a short paragraph telling the story of your latest journey to some faraway land. Try to imagine how it would have felt to be at sea for days at a time.

- Would you have been journeying for trade or to raid?
- Would there have been storms?
- Would you have been cold?
- Would you have been frightened or eager to get the job done and return home?

The Vikings believed that if they sailed too far they would be eaten by a giant sea serpent called Jörmungandr. Would you have feared Jörmungandr?

Viking ships versus modern technology

The Vikings were famous for their boatbuilding and their sailing skills, but the ships the Vikings sailed were very different to the ships we use today.

-  1 The table below compares the boats and ships used by the Vikings with modern-day boats and ships. Using the words in the word bank, fill in the blanks.

Viking boats and ships	Word bank	Modern-day boats and ships
Vikings built the hulls of their boats and ships from _____.	timber fibreglass	The hulls of modern boats and ships are usually built using metal or _____.
One of the longest Viking longships was thought to be the <i>Ormen Lange</i> . It was possibly 45 metres long, and it was able to carry heavy cargo and lots of _____. It had space for 34 oarsmen.	passengers <i>Giant</i> heaviest	The longest ship ever built was a super-tanker called <i>Seawise</i> _____. It was built in 1979, was 458 metres long and could carry the _____ load ever for a ship.
Historians believe that the Vikings probably used the _____ to help them navigate .	satellites stars	Modern boats and ships use navigation devices that send electronic signals to _____ in space.
Viking boats and ships could be powered by men (_____ with oars) or wind (if the ship had a _____).	propellers sail rowing	Modern ships are powered by huge engines. These engines are used to turn massive _____.
Viking _____ were the fastest ships built by the Vikings. The fastest a Viking longship could travel (under good _____) was approximately 15 knots (or 27.78 kilometres per hour).	speed conditions longships wood	The fastest boat ever built was the <i>Spirit of Australia</i> . It was a small, narrow, jet-powered boat made of _____ and designed to barely touch the water. Its top _____ was 276 knots (511.11 kilometres per hour).

Objectives

- Understand that beliefs influence behaviour and the study of belief systems is an important aspect of historical investigation
- Identify the most significant aspects of Norse mythology (i.e. the three worlds of the universe, the Norse creation myth, Valhalla and the most important Norse gods)
- Introduce students to Viking funerary customs

Prior knowledge

No prior knowledge required.

Background

The Vikings had a complex and interesting mythology. A mythology is a collection of stories used to explain the world, the creation and role of humans in the natural world, and the relationships between humans and gods. This mythology (and the beliefs that accompanied it) influenced the way the Vikings lived and fought, and underscored a host of their social behaviours.

Starter activity

When we study people from the past, it is important to think about the things they believed in. Belief systems influence laws and can shape the way people interact with each other. Use the following questions to encourage class discussion regarding the way present-day beliefs affect our society:

- Why do most people believe it is important to obey laws? How does this belief affect behaviour?
- What do some people believe happens when they die? How might these beliefs affect the way they live their lives?
- What are some positive effects of people having different belief systems?

Resource and Activity sheets

Students can read the Resource sheet 'The Norse universe' before completing the Activity sheet 'A complex mythology'. You might like to search the internet for pictorial representations of the Norse universe so that students are able to visualise the three world levels.

Students can read the Resource sheet 'Norse mythology' before completing the Activity sheet 'Understanding Norse mythology'. These sheets introduce students to the Norse creation myth and a handful of important gods.

The Activity sheet 'Valhalla' examines Viking beliefs about the afterlife and Viking funerary customs.

Extension activity

A society's funerary customs are strongly influenced by its belief systems. What do the funerary customs of our society say about us? Take a poll within the class. How many funerals have students attended? How were the funerals conducted? For example, was the deceased person buried or cremated, and was the funeral a religious or secular event? Be aware that some students may find it upsetting to talk about funerals they have attended, so make sure all discussion is voluntary.

The Norse universe

Viking mythology is usually called **Norse mythology**. 'Norse' simply means that it came from Scandinavia during the Viking era.

Norse mythology was full of courage, hardship and larger-than-life characters. It contained magic, as well as elves, giants and dwarfs. Norse mythology was strongly based on the natural environment. Trees, the sky, forests and snow all featured in its stories.

According to Norse mythology, there were three worlds that made up the universe:

- Asgard
- Midgard
- Niflheim.

The first world, **Asgard**, was where the gods of war and the gods of the sky lived. Asgard was full of wondrous halls and palaces made of silver and gold. The most brilliant of these halls was **Valhalla**. Elves and the Vanir (fertility gods who could see into the future) also lived here.

The second world was **Midgard** (which means the Middle World). Human beings lived in Midgard. Midgard was a fortress built by the gods and given to the Vikings to help protect them from the giants. Giants, dark elves and dwarfs lived on the same level as human beings, but in separate lands.

Between Asgard and Midgard was a huge and beautiful rainbow bridge called **Bifrost**. Anyone could use the bridge to travel between worlds but the journey was always very dangerous, even for the gods.

Finally, there was an **underworld** called **Niflheim** (which means land of the mists). Niflheim was also known as Hel, named after the goddess of the dead who ruled there. It was an icy, cold place and one that was feared by the Vikings.



A complex mythology

 Read the Resource sheet 'The Norse universe', and then answer the following questions and complete the activity.

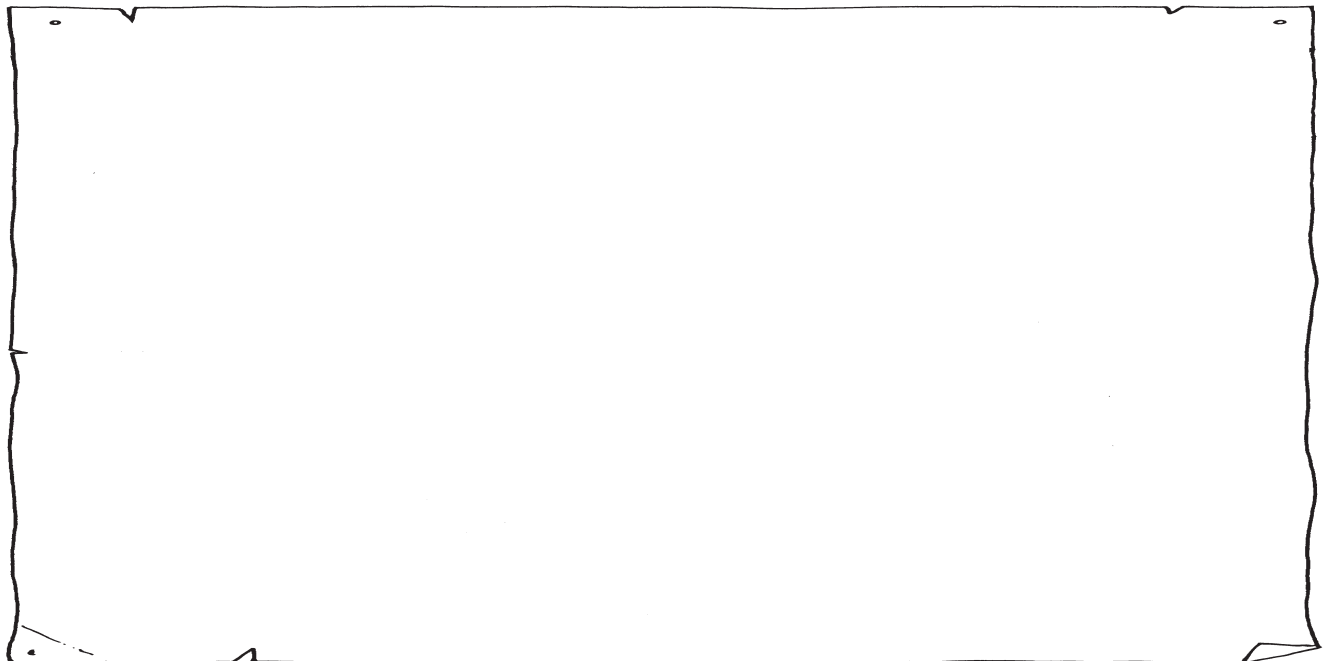
1 What were the three main worlds in Norse mythology?

2 What was the name of the bridge that linked Asgard and Midgard?

3 Who lived in Midgard? _____

4 Which was the world most feared by the Vikings? _____

5 In your workbook, draw what you think the Norse universe would look like. Make sure you include the three worlds (Asgard, Midgard and Niflheim). Be sure to also draw in the rainbow bridge, Bifrost. Label all these elements.



6 Draw yourself into the picture. In your workbook, write where you would have wanted to live and why.

Norse mythology

According to **Norse mythology**, there once lived a frightful giant made of frost, called Ymir. One day, the god **Odin** set out with his two brothers, Vili and Ve, to kill Ymir. They succeeded. They then made the Earth with Ymir's body and the sky with Ymir's skull. The seas and rivers were created from Ymir's blood. Odin and his brothers then created the first human beings. The first man was created from an ash tree, and the first woman was created from an elm tree.

Odin lived with other gods in **Asgard**. Asgard was the land of the **Aesir** (warrior gods) and the **Vanir** (sky gods). Odin was the father and ruler of all the gods, and he ruled over all human beings and other living creatures. Odin was also the god of war, wisdom, poetry and magic. He could create battles on Earth by throwing down his spear. He also liked to choose the winner of any war between humans. The Vikings did all they could to keep Odin happy so that he would favour them in battles.

Other important figures of Norse mythology are listed in the table below.

Name	Role	Fun fact
Frigg	Goddess of marriage, women and children	Wife of Odin and mother to Bragi (another god of poetry) and Balder (god of truth), Frigg was extremely smart and could see into the future.
Thor	God of thunder and lightning	Thor had a magic hammer that always struck its target before returning to his hand.
Heimdall	God of dawn and hospitality, and guardian of Asgard at Bifrost	Heimdall had a magic horn that would warn the gods of approaching danger.
Loki	God of fire and a trickster god	Loki was a spiteful god who was always playing tricks on other gods. One of these tricks caused the death of Balder, Odin's son.

Understanding Norse mythology

 Read the Resource sheet 'Norse mythology'. Then answer the following questions and complete the activities.

1 Who killed the frost giant, Ymir?

2 What did they do with the giant's body?

3 Who was Odin? _____

4 Why did the Vikings try to keep Odin happy?

5 Frigg was married to Odin. What was she the goddess of?

6 Thor was the god of thunder and lightning. What was special about Thor's hammer?

7 What was Heimdall the god of?

8 What did Loki do that annoyed the other gods?

9 Of the gods listed on the Resource sheet 'Norse mythology', who would be your favourite and why?

Valhalla

 1 Use the words in the word bank column to complete the paragraphs below.

	Word bank
For the Vikings, the most important thing in life – and death – was _____. They did their best to live an _____ life and to die an honourable death. They believed that how they died would determine where they would go in the _____.	honourable afterlife honour
When Vikings died they would either go to _____ or Niflheim. Valhalla was in Asgard and was the hall of the mighty god Odin. _____ was in the underworld and was presided over by Hel, goddess of the _____.	Niflheim dead Valhalla
It was the wish of all Viking warriors to go to Valhalla when they died. Valhalla was the most glorious hall in all of _____. There, the slain heroes would feast with Odin each night before heading out to battle in the _____. They would spend the day fighting and wounding each other, and then their _____ would heal overnight at _____.	wounds Asgard morning Valhalla
Valhalla was only for Viking warriors. The only way a Viking could get to Valhalla was if he died in battle. Vikings were scared of dying in their _____ in case they went to _____. The Valkyries – spirit maidens who obeyed Odin – would fly to a battlefield once the _____ was over. They would take the dead Vikings who had died fighting and return to Valhalla with them.	Niflheim fighting sleep
When a Viking died, they were either buried or _____ with their favourite belongings, so that they could carry these things into the next world. Important Vikings, such as kings and _____, were often buried or cremated with their ships, either on land or at sea. They might also be cremated on a funeral pyre , a tall _____ structure.	chieftains cremated wooden

Objectives

- Recognise the inventiveness and creativity of the Vikings
- Identify the influence of Viking inventions on future generations

Prior knowledge

No prior knowledge required.

Background

Despite their limited resources, the Vikings were very crafty people. Not only were they exceptional boatbuilders, they also invented lots of things we still use today, such as the magnetic compass. The Vikings had their own alphabet, called the futhark, and their weapons were more advanced than others of their time. The harsh conditions experienced by the Vikings may well have inspired them to think up ways to make their lives just that little bit easier.

Starter activity

What does the phrase 'necessity is the mother of invention' mean? Provide some examples of things that have been invented in response to specific needs.

Resource and Activity sheets

This unit contains five Activity sheets, the first four of which explore different aspects of Viking inventiveness. The Activity sheet 'Ready for battle' introduces students to weapons used by the Vikings. The Activity sheet 'Clothing and armour' describes the clothing and armour worn by Viking men and women. The Activity sheet 'Clever Vikings' introduces students to four Viking inventions. The Activity sheet 'The futhark' describes the Viking alphabet and invites students to create messages using the alphabet.

The final Activity sheet, 'Viking accomplishments', contains a crossword that includes various aspects of Viking inventiveness and culture that have been covered in the unit. The answers to the crossword clues are: ACROSS: 2 leather; 4 chainmail; 7 comb; 9 futhark; 10 spear; 12 axes; 13 sword. DOWN: 1 cloth; 3 metal; 4 compass; 5 loom; 6 cloak; 8 saex; 10 shield; 11 iron; 14 skis; 15 warp.

Extension activity

As a class, brainstorm a list of recent inventions that we live with or use during this modern age. Of these, which inventions are likely to stand the test of time and still be around in 500 years? Why will they still be relevant then? What ensures that an item will not date and will continue to be needed over time?

											
f	u	th	a	r	k	g	w	h	n	i	j
											
ae	p	z	s	t	b	e	m	l	ng	d	o

Ready for battle

-  1 Complete the following sentences by filling in the blanks with the correct words from the word bank.

Word bank					
spear	long	wood	wall	everyday	bows
shield	wood	Vikings	iron	saex	expensive
waves	combat	weapons	status		

Weapons were an important part of Viking life. All freemen had weapons and Viking law stated they could carry their w _ _ _ _ _ with them all the time.

Most Vikings went into battle carrying a _ h _ _ _ _ . These were round and made of _ _ _ _ d. During battles, Viking **warriors** would stand together in a line with their shields in front of them to create a shield w _ _ _ _ . This would protect them as they advanced. Shields could also be placed along the sides of ships to protect the crew from high _ _ _ v _ _ _ .

Axes made of **iron** were also common. They could be thrown or used to strike enemies.

Many Vikings used a _ _ _ e _ _ _ , which they could throw over _ _ _ _ g distances. They were roughly 3 metres long, made of wood and had a metal point. Vikings also used _ _ _ w _ _ and arrows to hit targets that were far away. The bows were made from _ _ _ _ d. The arrowheads were often made of i _ _ _ _ .

Most Vikings carried with them a hand knife called a s _ _ _ _ . It could be used to help with _ v _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ tasks, as well as being used in _ _ _ m _ _ _ _ .

Only wealthy Vikings used swords, as they were _ x _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ . Swords were _ _ _ _ _ u _ _ symbols. They were made of steel and were almost 1 metre long. They were sometimes decorated with silver.

Clothing and armour

The Vikings wore simple, warm clothes that they made from wool, **flax** and **linen**. Men wore plain pants with a **tunic** over the top. Women wore long dresses. Both wore long thick cloaks made of **felted wool** to protect them during cold days.

 **1** What sort of clothes do people wear now? What are they made of?

Vikings wore shoes made from leather, and their belts were made of leather or rope. They liked to decorate their clothes and made intricate (complicated and detailed) **braid trims** for important pieces of clothing. Pins were used to fasten clothes and cloaks. The pins were made of bone or metal and sometimes even gold.

2 What are your shoes made of? Did you make them yourself?

In battle, men wore **chainmail** over their tunics to protect them from sword blows. The chainmail was made of small metal rings bound together. It covered a man's torso as well as his upper arms and legs. Chainmail was expensive and heavy to wear, so not everyone wore it. Many men chose instead to wear **body armour** made of leather and quilted cloth. Helmets were made of iron, with a nose plate to protect the nose and a guard to protect the eyes.

3 What do modern-day police and soldiers wear to protect themselves?



Clever Vikings

 **1** Here are some examples of Viking inventions. Fill in the missing vowels to complete the sentences.

Haircombs

Th__ V__kings made ha__rcombs using d__ __r **antler**, bon__ and wood. Sp__cial craftsm__n mad__ the combs. Somet__mes th__y ev__n decor__ted them with carvings.

Magnetic compass

The Vik__ngs made the first magnetic c__mpass. They used __ typ__ of iron call__d **magnetite** to make the__r compasses. They then used these compasses to **navigate** across oceans and to f__nd their way in th__ dark.

The warp-weighted loom

The Vikings w__re not the first people to invent the **loom**, but they did invent a speci__l one. The warp-weighted loom was an upright loom w__th a crossbeam at the top. L__ngths of w__ol or flax hung from th__ top beam and were weighed d__wn using ston__s or ceramic we__ghts. Thes__ long vert__cal lengths are call__d the warp. The loom was used by th__ Vikings to make fabric for cloth__s.

Skis

The V__kings made long skis o__t of pin__ wo__d. These skis were __lmost 2 metres long.

2 Insert the missing vowels from above into the spaces below. Put them in the same order and discover the hidden message.

Th__ V__k__ngs w__r__ v__ry cl__v__r.
Th__y __nv__nt__d m__ny th__ngs t__ m__k__
th__r l__v__s __s__r. S__m__ __f
th__ th__ngs th__y __nv__nt__d w__ st__ll
__s__ t__d__y.

The futhark

The Viking alphabet is called the **futhark**. The name 'futhark' was created by combining the first six letters of this alphabet. Each letter represents a sound, but each also has **symbolic meaning**. For example, the symbol for the letter 'r' also meant 'ride', and the symbol for the letter 's' also meant 'sun'.

											
f	u	th	a	r	k	g	w	h	n	i	j
											
ae	p	z	s	t	b	e	m	l	ng	d	o



- Write the following words using the Viking futhark. Simply replace each letter with the corresponding futhark letter. If a letter is not in the futhark alphabet, just leave it out.

Your first name: _____

Your last name: _____

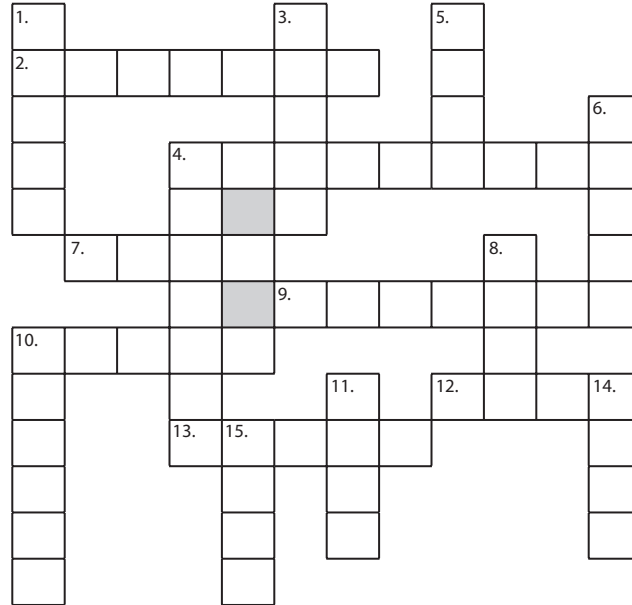
The name of one of your friends:

The name of your school:

Try writing a secret message to one of your classmates using the futhark alphabet.

Viking accomplishments

 1 Find the Viking accomplishments hidden in the crossword.



Across

- | | |
|--|---|
| 2. The Vikings made their shoes out of this. | 9. The name of the Viking alphabet |
| 4. The Vikings linked rows of metal rings to make _____ to protect them in battle. | 10. This was a weapon that a Viking could throw over a long distance. |
| 7. The Vikings created a _____ for their hair using wood or antler. | 12. These were common weapons as well as useful tools. |
| | 13. This weapon was expensive. Wealthy people would decorate theirs. |

Down

1. The Vikings wove linen to make _____.
3. The Vikings used _____ on the end of their spears.
4. The Vikings used a magnetic _____ to help them navigate.
5. The Vikings used the warp-weighted _____ to make their clothes.
6. A Viking man or woman wore this to help protect them from the cold.
8. A Viking handknife was called a _____.
10. This was round and made of wood. It helped a Viking protect himself during battle.
11. Vikings used this strong metal to make weapons.
14. The Vikings made these using long planks of wood. They made it easier to travel over snow.
15. The _____-weighted loom was a useful piece of equipment.

Objectives

- Recognise the links between the Viking raids and the Vikings' expansion throughout Europe and beyond
- Understand the reasons why the Vikings raided villages, cities and monasteries, and why those raids were generally successful
- Consider the effects of raids on the people being raided
- Develop some skills at interpreting a primary source

Prior knowledge

Students should have basic map-reading skills, including an understanding of the location of Europe.

Background

Throughout the three centuries that the Vikings dominated Europe, it was violence and the threat of violence that made their conquests possible. Viking raids were sudden, swift and destructive. People were killed or enslaved, items of value were stolen and many raided villages were left ablaze. The Danegeld evolved as a means of appeasing the Vikings and protecting people and property.

Starter activity

What is a raid? Ask students to look up the word in a dictionary and write the definition in their workbooks. Invite students to brainstorm reasons why raids would have been an effective way of dominating a region. Write their responses on the board.

Resource and Activity sheets

Students can read the Resource sheet 'Viking raids' and then complete the Activity sheet 'Conquered by Vikings'. The Resource sheet emphasises the fact that Vikings saw raids as battles rather than acts of theft.

Students can read the Resource sheet 'Lindisfarne 1' and complete the Activity sheet 'Lindisfarne 2' in small groups. This Activity sheet may be difficult for some students; you may need to help them with interpreting the language used in the *Anglo-Saxon Chronicle* excerpt.

The final Activity sheet, 'Danegeld – paying off the Vikings', can be completed by students individually. This sheet combines grammatical knowledge with an understanding of the Danegeld. The final exercise invites students to consider the effect of the Danegeld on farmers at the time.

Extension activity

Play the game 'Viking Quest' on the BBC History website. This game invites students to build a ship, cross the seas, loot a monastery and return home to claim their prize. The village chieftain then determines whether the raid has been a success or not. The game lasts approximately 5–7 minutes per go and is designed as an educational resource. It can be accessed by visiting the BBC website at www.bbc.co.uk/history/ancient/vikings/launch_gms_viking_quest.shtml

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Viking raids

For centuries, the Vikings sailed their way throughout much of Europe, attacking villages as they went. One of the first and most famous Viking raids took place at the **monastery** at **Lindisfarne**, in northern England. A monastery is a place where a community of monks or nuns lives. Vikings attacked monasteries because they were poorly defended and those who lived there had no weapons. Monasteries also often held lots of valuable things, such as gold, food, animals and jewels.

During raids, the Vikings would burn buildings, kill people, take women and children as **slaves**, and steal any riches they found. The Vikings did not see raiding as stealing. They were very proud and honourable people. They believed that stealing was a terrible act and if you stole something you would have a horrible afterlife. Instead, they saw raids as honourable battles in which the **victor** (the winning side) was allowed to keep the **spoils of war** (all the valuable items that they took from the losing side).

Viking raids were very successful for a few reasons. Firstly, the Vikings could sneak up quietly in their boats and take villages and monasteries by surprise. Secondly, raids were known to be fierce and bloody, so people often ran away or **surrendered**. The Vikings then moved on to the next place just as quickly as they had arrived.



Conquered by Vikings

 Read the Resource sheet 'Viking raids'. Answer the following questions.

1 Where did one of the first and most famous Viking attacks take place?

2 Write down one reason why Vikings attacked monasteries.

3 'In a raid, the Vikings killed everyone.' Is this statement true or false?

4 Write down two reasons why Viking raids were so successful.

5 The Vikings believed that it was wrong to steal. How did they justify what they did in a raid?

6 What is meant by the phrase 'the spoils of war'?



Lindisfarne 1

In 793 CE, Vikings attacked a monastery at Lindisfarne. Lindisfarne is a small island off the north-eastern coast of England. The monastery contained many religious **relics** (historical objects). It was also an important **centre of learning**.

The raid was **swift** and **brutal**. Many monks were killed, and some were taken as slaves. The monastery was burned and valuable items were stolen. After the raid, the remaining monks fled Lindisfarne with whatever relics they had managed to save.

The following account of the Viking raid at Lindisfarne was recorded in the *Anglo-Saxon Chronicle*. *The Anglo-Saxon Chronicle* is a collection of historical records written in England between the 9th and 12th centuries. It is an example of a **primary historical source**, which means that it was created during the historical period that is being studied.

This year came dreadful fore-warnings over the land of the Northumbrians, terrifying the people most woefully: these were immense sheets of light rushing through the air, and whirlwinds, and fiery dragons flying across the firmament. These tremendous tokens were soon followed by a great famine: and not long after, on the sixth day before the ides of January in the same year, the harrowing inroads of heathen men made lamentable havoc in the church of God in Holy-island [Lindisfarne], by rapine and slaughter.

Lindisfarne 2

 Read the Resource sheet 'Lindisfarne 1'. Work in small groups to complete the activities on this sheet.

1 Match each phrase to its meaning, by drawing a line between the two.

'terrifying the people most woefully'	flaming arrows flying across the sky
'fiery dragons flying across the firmament'	the middle of January
'the ides of January'	really scaring the people

2 Write down what you think each of these phrases means.

a) 'followed by a great famine'

b) 'the harrowing inroads of heathen men'

c) 'made lamentable havoc'

d) 'by rapine and slaughter'

3 Rewrite the excerpt from the *Anglo-Saxon Chronicle* using modern-day language. Write your version in your workbook.

Danegeld – paying off the Vikings

A **proper noun** refers to the name of a person, place, group, event or important object. Examples of proper nouns are 'England' and 'Ingrid'. Proper nouns start with a capital letter. A **common noun** is the name given to a type of person, place or thing. Examples of common nouns are 'chair', 'boat' and 'men'.

-  **1** Identify whether the underlined words below are common nouns or proper nouns by circling the correct option.

Viking raids were organised and brutal. Few cities survived a Viking raid and most people – including rulers (common noun / proper noun) – were scared of being attacked and killed.

In 810 CE, more than 200 Viking ships (common noun / proper noun) attacked a place called Frisia (common noun / proper noun). The Vikings demanded a bounty (a lot of money) in return for not destroying the area. The people of Frisia gave them 45 kilograms of silver (common noun / proper noun). This payment came to be known as Danegeld (common noun / proper noun), which means 'Danish gold'. Over time, the Danegeld became a way of paying off the Vikings so that they wouldn't attack. To raise the money (common noun / proper noun) needed to pay the Vikings, kings (common noun / proper noun) charged their people a Danegeld tax.

The Danegeld was commonly used as a way of avoiding Viking attacks for 300 years. During that time (common noun / proper noun), many tonnes of silver were given to the Vikings. In return, the Vikings would agree to settle in an area (common noun / proper noun) and rule it fairly without violence. Sometimes the Vikings would take the silver and return to Scandinavia (common noun / proper noun).

- 2** Imagine you were a farmer living in England. How would you have felt about having to pay the Danegeld tax? Write your answer in your workbook.

Objectives

- Understand what trade is and why studying it is an important part of historical studies
- Identify some of the items traded by Vikings
- Identify key trading locations and routes
- Introduce students to Erik the Red, a Viking committed to the expansion of Viking trade

Prior knowledge

Students should have some geographical knowledge and an understanding of where the Vikings came from. They should also know the location of key countries in Europe (such as England, France and Spain) and Russia.

Background

Aided by their prowess as sailors and their success with raiding, the Vikings were exceptional traders who built extensive and complex trade networks. Many trade ports and cities were either founded or expanded by the Vikings, with the settlement of these ports and cities being one of the central factors in their dominance.

Starter activity

Who do we trade with? Think about the various cities, states and countries we trade with. Do certain goods tend to be associated with a particular country? If so, which goods and which countries? Do trade relations matter? How well do you think your town/city/nation would survive if it didn't trade with other people? Are there certain items you simply wouldn't have were it not for trade?

Resource and Activity sheets

Students should work with a partner to complete the Activity sheet 'Trade matters'. This Activity sheet encourages students to consider the role of trade in history as well as in their own time.

Students can read the Resource sheet 'The Vikings as traders' then complete the Activity sheet 'Viking trade'. These sheets explore the role Viking trade played in expanding commodities throughout the world.

Finally, students can read the Resource sheet 'Erik the Red' before completing the Activity sheet 'Erik the Red expands Viking trade'. These sheets examine the role of Erik the Red in the colonisation of Greenland.

Extension activity

This activity is designed to show students how extensive modern trade routes are, and how we tend to take them for granted. The students are required to complete the first section as homework.

Each student should select two items of food from their pantry at home. They should write down the name of each item, as well as the name of the country it came from (this information is on the label, but you might need to explain this to students first).

In class, on a large map of the world, write all the food items recorded by the students and mark the countries that these items came from.

How wide-ranging is global trade? How does it compare to trade during the Viking Age?

Trade matters

Trade refers to the buying and selling of **goods** and **services** between people. Trade can happen within a village, or it can take place between different countries.

Throughout history, people have **exchanged** goods. Historians know, for example, that even in the Stone Age humans in different areas exchanged one type of rock (flint) for another (obsidian). As civilisations grew and people began to travel further, they traded with people from other cities and then other countries.

Archaeologists and historians like to study the trading habits of people who lived long ago. It gives them information about a lot of things, such as:

- what items were considered valuable enough to trade with
- which peoples and countries traded with each other
- where trading took place (for example, in a market or in a port)
- how items that came from one culture ended up somewhere completely different
- what the most common land and sea **trade routes** were.

 Work with a partner to complete the following activity.

- 1 Imagine you are historians from the future and you are writing a book about the trading habits of people who live in your city right now.

What sort of things do they buy?	What do they use to buy things with?
Are there special marketplaces where people get together to trade? Where are they?	How do goods arrive at these marketplaces? How do people get these goods back to their homes?

The Vikings as traders

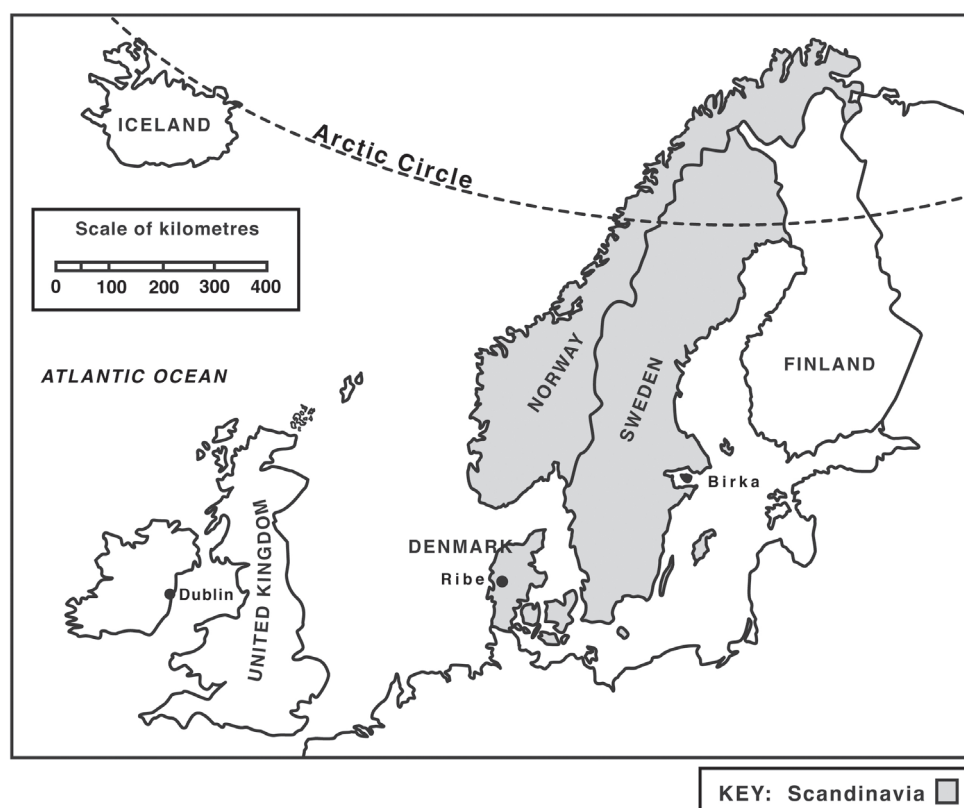
The Vikings were great traders. Their skills as sailors made it possible for them to travel between countries, and their large boats helped them carry goods from one place to another.

As the Vikings travelled further, to other countries throughout Europe and towards Asia, they traded with different peoples. They traded the furs they hunted as well as wood, wool, leather, honey and other items for silver, silk, jewellery, weapons and spices.

The Vikings also bought and sold slaves. During Viking raids, local people were taken by the Vikings and enslaved. These slaves were then taken to Viking settlements to work or taken to other cities to be traded. **Slave trading** was common throughout most parts of Europe during the Viking Age.

Many cities and ports in Europe were created or expanded by the Vikings through trade. For example, the Vikings **founded** Dublin in Ireland and Birka in Sweden. They also traded with people as far east as Russia.

The Vikings created a complex **network** of **trade routes** over land and sea. These routes covered Scandinavia, most of Europe, the northern part of the Atlantic Ocean and the Mediterranean area. Historians know where the Vikings traded because they have found Viking **artefacts** in these areas.



Viking trade

Read the Resource sheet 'The Vikings as traders', then complete the following activities.

-  **1** Choose the correct words from the word bank to complete the following paragraph.

Word bank

network trade items sailors large

Vikings were great _____ and this made it possible for them to _____ with people in many different cities and countries. Their boats were _____. This meant they could carry many _____ from one place to another. The Vikings had a complex _____ of trade routes and were the most successful traders of their time.

- 2** Are the following statements true or false?

- | | | |
|---|------|-------|
| a) The Vikings only traded with the Russians. | True | False |
| b) The Vikings were very successful traders. | True | False |
| c) The Vikings traded with Indigenous Australians. | True | False |
| d) The Vikings founded Dublin in Ireland. | True | False |

- 3** Name two goods that the Vikings sold.

- 4** Name two goods that the Vikings bought.

- 5** It was common for people to trade slaves during the Viking Age. Today, any sort of slave trade is illegal. Write down two reasons why modern-day people think slave trading is wrong.

Erik the Red

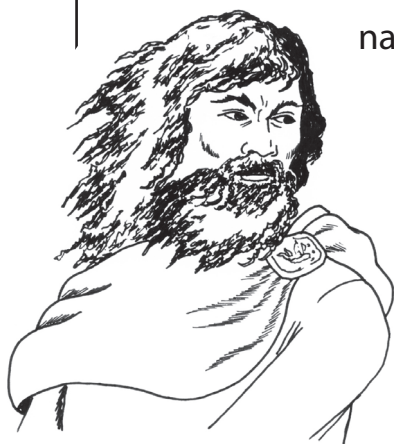
My name is Erik the Red. I was born in Norway in 950 CE. My full name is Erik Thorvaldsson. People call me 'Red' because I have red hair.

I moved from Norway to Iceland with my parents. When I was 32 years old, I killed several people. I was then **exiled** (barred) from Iceland for three years.

I decided to spend that time sailing and exploring other lands. I discovered a place I called Greenland. No Vikings or other Europeans lived there. I liked the idea of living away from all the people I had fought with back in Iceland.

Once my three-year exile was finished, I sailed back to Iceland. I told people how wonderful Greenland was. I figured the name 'Greenland' would make it sound like a nice place to live, and I was right. Lots of people decided to come back with me. In 986 CE we left Iceland and sailed to Greenland.

We started up two **colonies** in Greenland. Both were on the south-west coast, as the land there was better for farming. In summer, men from both colonies would travel north to hunt seals and whales for their meat, and walrus for their tusks. Life was tough. It was very cold and sea ice made sailing difficult. We also fought from time to time with the native **Inuits**.



My son, Leif Eriksson, eventually left Greenland and explored Vinland (North America). I was to have gone with him, but I changed my mind. I never saw my son again.

Erik the Red expands Viking trade



1 Read the Resource sheet 'Erik the Red'. Unscramble the words below.

- a) Glanenerd _ _ e e _ _ _ _ _
- b) dexile _ x _ _ _ d
- c) dumrer m _ _ d _ _
- d) plexgroin _ x _ _ _ i _ _
- e) liVdann V _ _ l _ _ _
- f) ywoNra N _ _ _ _ y
- g) fLei _ e i _
- h) oolcngiins _ _ _ _ n _ _ _ n _
- i) lcedanl l _ _ _ a _ _
- j) nsosavdlThro _ h _ _ v _ _ _ _ _ _

2 Use the unscrambled words from Question 1 to complete the sentences below.

Erik the Red's full name was Erik _____. He was born in _____. He is most famous for _____ Greenland. The word 'colonising' means to settle in a new country.

Erik the Red was _____ from _____ for three years because he committed _____. He spent his time sailing and _____. When he returned to Iceland he told everyone about the wonderful new land he had found. He called the new land _____ because he thought it would make people want to live there.

Lots of people returned to Greenland with Erik the Red. They set up two colonies. These colonies survived for 500 years.

Erik the Red's son was _____ Eriksson. He left Greenland to explore _____. The winter after Leif sailed away, Erik the Red became ill and died.

Teacher's notes – Did the Vikings discover North America?

Achieve!

Objectives

- Understand what is meant by an artefact, a fossil and a primary source
- Learn about the location and historical relevance of L'anse aux Meadows
- Recognise how far from Scandinavia the Vikings travelled

Prior knowledge

Students should have some basic map-reading skills and be able to identify Scandinavia, Europe and North America.

Background

Christopher Columbus is credited with being the first European explorer to discover North America. However, as recently as the 1960s a small group of archaeologists found proof of Viking settlement in a small coastal village in North America. The discovery of Viking artefacts at L'anse aux Meadows confirmed that the Vikings had discovered at least this small part of the North American coastline, many centuries ahead of Christopher Columbus.

Starter activity

How does the stuff that we leave behind give others clues as to how we lived? Divide the class into small groups. Give each group a sheet of paper with a list of items on it. One list may have, for example, a teddy bear, a dummy, a bag of nappies, a bag of wool with knitting needles, a rocking chair, a pair of spectacles, a range of cake tins, a rolling pin, one bed and one cot, and a closet full of women's clothing. Tell each group that they have to hypothesise, based on the evidence left behind, who lived in the house where the items were found, how old they may have been and what sex they were. Invite each group to also make up a theory as to why the inhabitants of the house disappeared. Each group can present their findings to the rest of the class.

Resource and Activity sheets

Students can read the Resource sheet 'Artefacts, fossils and primary sources' before completing the Activity sheet 'Unearthing the past'. These sheets help students learn how to distinguish between artefacts and fossils, and how to identify primary sources. Students may require additional support and explanation in order to understand what a fossil is. A good website to visit is www.oum.ox.ac.uk/thezone/fossils/intro/form.htm, which is hosted by the Oxford University Museum of Natural History.

Students can read the Resource sheet 'The artefacts of L'anse aux Meadow' before completing the Activity sheet 'Artefact detective work'. These sheets encourage students to deduce behaviours by using primary evidence.

Finally, students can work with a partner to complete the Activity sheet 'The Vikings and North America'.

Extension activity

What is the Arctic Circle? Working in pairs, students can research online (using internet search engines such as Firefox or Google) what the Arctic Circle is, where it is located, how cold the region is and how icy conditions hamper sea travel. Students can then produce an information booklet on the Arctic Circle region. The information booklet should be produced with a Viking reader in mind and should contain basic details as well as possible tips on how to survive in this region.

Suggested web addresses were functional at the time of publication but teachers should check them for inappropriate content and to ensure that they are still functional before use with students.

Artefacts, fossils and primary sources

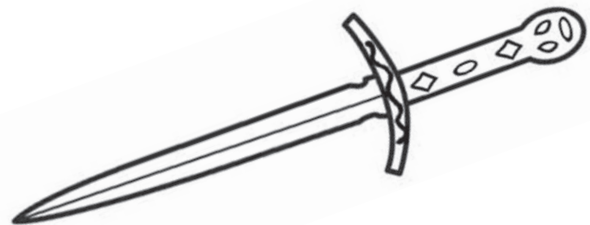
An **artefact** is an object that was made by people long ago. Artefacts could be something natural that humans reshaped (such as a flint knife) or they could be items that involved a lot of work (such as a decorated bowl). Artefacts usually lie forgotten and buried for years – sometimes hundreds or thousands of years – before being rediscovered by archaeologists.

Archaeologists study the past. They visit areas where people lived and **excavate** these sites looking for artefacts. They use special tools to scrape and brush away soil. They work very slowly and carefully to uncover artefacts without breaking them.

Artefacts are called **primary sources** because they come from the actual historical period that is being studied. Historians can use primary sources to work out what life was like during a specific time in history.

Not all artefacts survive. Some artefacts – such as clothes made of wool – decay over time or decay underground. Others might be washed away in storms or taken by explorers.

A **fossil** is a very different thing from an artefact. An artefact is something that was made by people. A fossil, on the other hand, is the remains or the impression of something that was once alive long ago. There are two main types of fossils – animal fossils and plant fossils.



Artefacts, such as handmade weapons, tell us about life long ago.

Unearthing the past

Read the Resource sheet 'Artefacts, fossils and primary sources'.

 **1** Below is a list of words and definitions. Draw a line to link each word to its correct definition.

- | | |
|-------------------------|--|
| a) artefact | to rot away |
| b) archaeologist | the remains or impression of something that used to be alive |
| c) excavate | a person who studies past people and cultures |
| d) decay | to unearth something |
| e) evidence | something made by a person who lived long ago |
| f) fossil | proof |

2



I want to be an archaeologist when I grow up. I practise by digging up things in my backyard.
Help me decide if these things are artefacts or fossils.

- | | |
|---------------|----------------------|
| A bone _____ | An axe _____ |
| A doll _____ | A watch _____ |
| A tooth _____ | Petrified wood _____ |
| A nail _____ | A bowl _____ |

3 Write down one reason why archaeologists have to excavate so carefully.

The artefacts of L'anse aux Meadows

The Vikings told long elaborate tales, called **sagas**. These sagas were passed on **orally** from one **generation** to the next. Then, between the 12th and 14th centuries, the sagas were written down. The sagas told of Viking kings, battles and great journeys. For a long time, historians didn't know whether any part of the sagas was real or if it was all make-believe.

One of the sagas told the story of Leif Eriksson and his discovery of a place called Vinland. Some historians thought that Vinland may be in North America – but they had no proof. Then in the 1960s, a group of archaeologists discovered the remains of a Viking village in a place called L'anse aux Meadows, on the island of Newfoundland, off the eastern coast of Canada.



Archaeologists uncovered many things at L'anse aux Meadows. Among them were:

- the **foundations** of eight Viking buildings
- the remains of a fireplace
- a bronze pin
- a stone oil lamp
- a spindle whorl (for spinning wool) made of stone
- some needles made of bone
- a small pair of scissors.

Artefact detective work

 L'anse aux Meadows is the only Viking site to be discovered in North America. In 1978, it was named a World Heritage Site.

1 Give two reasons why it is considered such an important site.

2 Are the following statements true or false?

- | | | |
|--|------|-------|
| a) The knitting needles, scissors and spindle whorl point to women living there. | True | False |
| b) The stone lamp is proof that Vikings liked to read books at night. | True | False |
| c) The fireplace tells us that Vikings used fire to stay warm and cook their food. | True | False |
| d) The building foundations give us an idea of how big a Viking home was. | True | False |
| e) The small scissors were made of plastic. | True | False |

3 Match the sentence starter with the correct ending, by drawing a line between the two.

- | | |
|-------------------------------------|---|
| a) The Vikings told long stories | full of lies.
called sagas.
known as fairytales. |
| b) Leif Eriksson settled in | North America.
Australia.
the North Pole. |
| c) L'anse aux Meadow is located off | the eastern coast of Canada.
the western coast of Canada.
the eastern coast of England. |

The Vikings and North America

 Work with a partner to complete the following activities.

1 Fill in the blanks using the words in the word bank column.

	Word bank
Eight building foundations were uncovered at L'anse aux Meadows. Among these _____ were an iron workshop (called a smithy) and a workshop for repairing _____. Another building was used for _____.	boats carpentry buildings
_____ had many forests. This meant there was a lot of timber for the _____ to harvest. Much of the timber they cut down was transported back to Greenland. It was most likely used to build _____ and boats. It would also have been used to trade with other people.	houses Vikings Vinland
The Vikings only lived in Vinland for a short time. Most _____ believe that they were there for less than _____ years. Two main _____ are given for why their stay was so short.	reasons ten historians
The first reason is that there was lots of fighting between the Vikings and the _____ people of the area. The second reason is that it was too _____ and difficult to live in Vinland, so the Vikings returned home to _____.	cold Greenland native

2 Starting a new colony in a strange land would have had its good points and its bad points. Write down two advantages to being part of a new colony.

3 Write down two disadvantages to being part of a new colony.

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